

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 5
 ♥ 8 6 3
 ♦ 10 9 6 5 4
 ♣ A 9 6

♠ A K Q 9 8 3

♥ 2

♦ A K

♣ K Q J 8



♠ 6
 ♥ A J 10 9 7
 ♦ Q J 7 3
 ♣ 10 4 2

♠ J 7 4 2

♥ K Q 5 4

♦ 8 2

♣ 7 5 3

SOUTH's 3♠ supporting bid is enough to convince NORTH to make a slam try.

NORTH bids Blackwood 4NT. If SOUTH shows one Ace NORTH plans to bid 6♠, but when SOUTH bids 5♣ NORTH settles for 5♠

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	5♠		
All Pass			
5♠ by North			
Lead: ♦Q			

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 9 8 7 5

♥ 7 4

♦ 7 6 5 4

♣ A 6

♠ A 6 4

♥ K J 9

♦ A K Q J 9

♣ K Q



♠ Q 10 2

♥ 5 3 2

♦ 8 2

♣ 9 8 5 3 2

♠ J 3

♥ A Q 10 8 6

♦ 10 3

♣ J 10 7 4

SOUTH makes a positive 3♥ response to NORTH's 2♣ opener. This promises at least 8 points and a 5-card suit with two or more honors.

NORTH only needs to know one thing - how many Aces in the SOUTH hand. A Blackwood 4NT tells her the answer is one, so she bids 6♥.

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♦
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			
6♥ by South			
Lead: ♣A			

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8 3
♥ A 10 5 3
♦ J 9 7 3
♣ 10 8

♠ A 9 7

♥ Q J 4 2

♦ K Q 8 6

♣ A 5



♠ J 6 5 4 2

♥ 9 8 7

♦ 10 5 2

♣ 6 4

♠ K Q

♥ K 6

♦ A 4

♣ K Q J 9 7 3 2

When NORTH opens 1NT, point-count alone tells SOUTH that 6NT can surely be made. NORTH is bound to hold at least two Aces. But SOUTH doesn't want to miss a Grand slam.

SOUTH bids 4♣, (Gerber), and NORTH admits to just two Aces.

So SOUTH settles for the small slam.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♠	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by North			
Lead: ♠4			

Board 4

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ 8
 ♥ Q 10
 ♦ J 9 6 5 4 2
 ♣ Q J 3 2

♠ J 9 5 2
 ♥ A J 7 4 3
 ♦ A Q
 ♣ 9 8



♠ 10 7
 ♥ 9 8 6 2
 ♦ 10 8
 ♣ 10 7 6 5 4

♠ A K Q 6 4 3
 ♥ K 5
 ♦ K 7 3
 ♣ A K

SOUTH has a powerhouse and knows she will reach a slam somewhere. When NORTH supports the ♠s, it seems she has found her spot.

Blackwood tells her that NORTH has two Aces. She can see there are 12 tricks available and decides to take a chance that NORTH will have a thirteenth trick somewhere among his opening hand points.

She bids 7NT.

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♥	Pass	7NT
All Pass			
7NT by South			
Lead: ♣Q			

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 10 6 5

♥ 7 2

♦ 10 9 5

♣ A 9 7 2

♠ J 7 3

♥ A J 10 9 8

♦ 8 3 2

♣ Q 8



♠ 9 8 4

♥ 4 3

♦ A 7 6 4

♣ 10 5 4 3

♠ A K 2

♥ K Q 6 5

♦ K Q J

♣ K J 6

SOUTH is tempted to go right to 6♥ when she hears NORTH's positive response. BUT, she should use Blackwood first.

It's good thing she did because NORTH admits to only one Ace - they are missing two Aces.

*West**North**East**South*

2♣

Pass

2♥

Pass

4NT

Pass

5♦

Pass

5♥

All Pass

5♥ by North

Lead: ♦A